Name: CHANDANA L N
Registration number: RA2511056010357
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21LEM202T — Unit 1, Session 5, SLO 1

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Excitement or Happiness?

For each source, mark whether it is continuous & independent (happiness) or temporary & dependent (excitement).

Source	Continuous / independent OR temporary / dependent
Right understanding (in the self)	**Continuous / independent**
Right feeling — ensured in the self	**Continuous / independent**
Favourable sensation (tasty food, music…)	**Temporary / dependent**
Attention / appreciation from others	**Temporary / dependent**

Activity 2 — Sources of Happiness

Complete the table from the session.

Source	Ensured in self / from other / through body	Continuous or temporary?
Right understanding	**Ensured in self**	**Continuous**
Right feeling	**Ensured in self**	**Continuous**
Sensation	**Through body**	**Temporary**

Activity 3 — Respond to a Prevailing Notion

Pick one and write your response after today's discussion:

- "I will be bored of happiness if I am always happy."
- "The richer you are, the more prosperous you are."

I choose the second notion: "The richer you are, the more prosperous you are." After today's discussion, I understand that prosperity is not about accumulating wealth but about having a feeling of having enough and being able to fulfill all my needs. A rich person may still feel deprived and unhappy, while someone with modest means can feel prosperous if they are content and have right understanding. Therefore, wealth alone does not define prosperity.

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Distinguish between happiness and excitement, with reference to the three sources of happiness.

Happiness is a state of inner fulfillment and harmony that arises from right understanding, right relationships, and right use of physical facilities, and it is continuous and sustainable. Excitement, in contrast, is a temporary, sensation-based emotional high that depends on external stimuli and fades quickly, often leading to a craving for more. The three sources of happiness are: (1) oneself (through self-exploration and right understanding), (2) other human beings (through mutual fulfillment in relationships), and (3) nature (through physical facilities used responsibly). Excitement typically arises only from sensation (a subset of physical facility) and does not involve the deeper sources of happiness.

Q2. Examine the prevailing notion that “accumulation of wealth = prosperity.”

The prevailing notion equates prosperity with the accumulation of wealth, but this is incomplete and misleading. True prosperity includes not only having adequate physical facilities but also feeling a sense of fulfillment and sharing with others. Accumulation of wealth alone often leads to greed, insecurity, and a lack of harmony in relationships, whereas genuine prosperity involves right utilization of resources for the well-being of oneself, others, and nature. Therefore, wealth accumulation is only one aspect; prosperity requires a holistic understanding of human goals.

Q3. Explain why dependence on sensation, on physical facility, and on feeling received from others cannot give continuous happiness, and what the role of sensation actually is.

Dependence on sensation cannot give continuous happiness because sensations are temporary and subject to habituation — the same stimulus produces less pleasure over time, requiring ever stronger stimuli. Dependence on physical facility alone fails because material objects are limited and external; they do not address inner needs for meaning, relationships, and self-understanding. Dependence on feelings received from others (e.g., praise, approval) is unreliable because others' responses are variable and not under one's control. The actual role of sensation is to provide information about the physical world and to serve as a signal for survival and well-being, not as a source of lasting happiness. Sensation is a tool, not a goal.